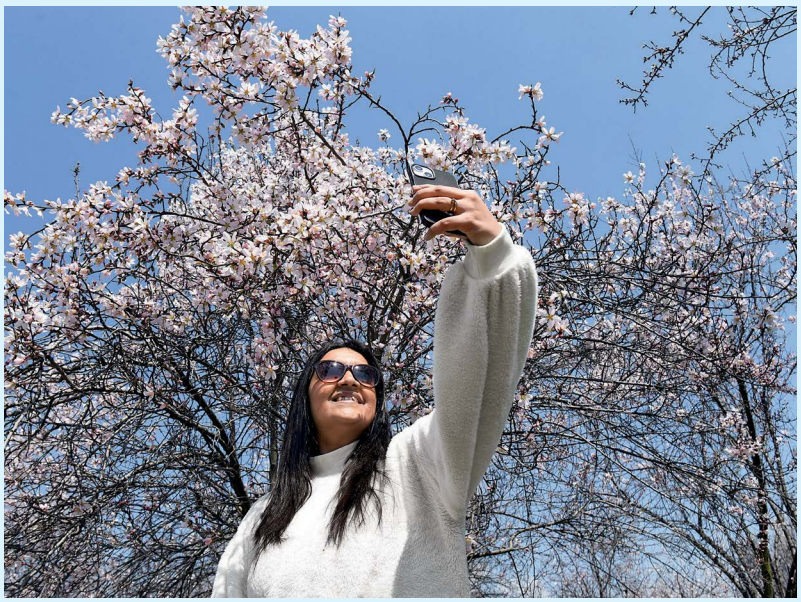
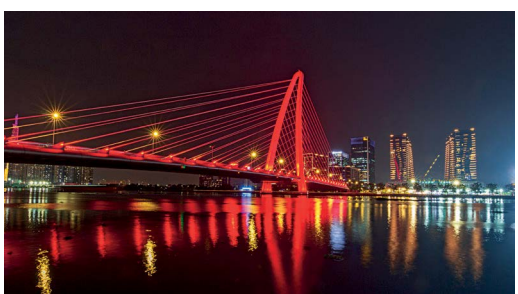
Spring is in the Air



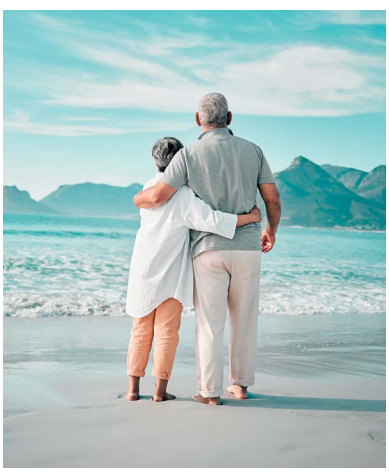
Srinagar's almond trees are in bloom, and nowhere more stunningly than at Badamwari, a historical garden set in the foothills of Hari Parbat Fort. The almond blossoms, some of the first to appear as spring comes to the valley, are a sight to behold, and herald the start of Kashmir's flower season. Asia's largest tulip garden had its annual reopening in Srinagar on March 26 with much fanfare. Cherry and pear blossoms will follow, not to mention the numerous wildflowers across the meadows of Kashmir. The horticulture department has also planted thousands of lavender plants in the upper reaches of Badamwari and plans to turn it into a themed garden. Provence in paradise?

Nam for the Gram

Vietnam has seen a surge in tourists from India in recent years. From 138,000 in 2022, the number of Indian travellers to Vietnam grew to 392,000 in 2023, before reaching a whopping 501,000 in 2024. India is now the sixth-largest international tourist market for Vietnam. This growth is in part thanks to the launch of direct flights between the two countries. Low-cost carrier Vietjet, which debuted in India in 2019, further strengthened its presence in the country with the launch of new direct flights connecting Hyderabad and Bengaluru to Ho Chi Minh City on March 18 and 19, respectively. A.k.a. Saigon, Ho Chi Minh City is the economic powerhouse of Vietnam and famed for its street food and proximity to major tourist attractions. While Hyderabad to Ho Chi Minh City flights are twice a week, Bengaluru to Ho Chi Minh City is a thrice-weekly service.



TRAVEL MADE EASY FOR SENIORS



Online travel booking platform EaseMyTrip has announced a strategic partnership with Sukoon Unlimited, a premium senior care service provider, to offer exclusive benefits tailored for senior citizens. The collaboration aims to make travel more accessible, comfortable and stress-free for elderly travellers booking flights through EaseMyTrip. Offerings include personalised assistance to make booking flights effortless, exclusive discounts, priority seating, wheelchair assistance, and on-ground support at airports for those in need. Beyond these travel conveniences, Sukoon Unlimited will offer complimentary wellness services such as pre- and post-travel consultations, ensuring that senior travellers are well-prepared and receive the necessary care. Senior citizens can look forward to a seamless travel experience with these specially designed services.